

Diabetic Neuropathy - NIDDK

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Diabetic Neuropathy - NIDDK Home Health Information Diabetes Diabetes Overview Preventing Diabetes Problems Diabetic Neuropathy English English Español Related Topics Diabetic Neuropathy View or Print All Sections Diabetic neuropathy is nerve damage that can occur in people with diabetes. Different types of nerve damage cause different symptoms. Symptoms can range from pain and numbness in your feet to problems with the functions of your internal organs, such as your heart and bladder. What Is Diabetic Neuropathy? Diabetic neuropathy is nerve damage that is caused by diabetes. Over time, high blood glucose levels, also called blood sugar, and high levels of fats, such as triglycerides, in the blood from diabetes can damage your nerves. Symptoms depend on which type of diabetic neuropathy you have. Peripheral Neuropathy Peripheral neuropathy is a type of nerve damage that typically affects the feet and legs and sometimes affects the hands and arms. This type of neuropathy is very common. About one-third to one-half of people with diabetes have peripheral neuropathy. Autonomic Neuropathy Autonomic neuropathy is damage to nerves that control your internal organs, leading to problems with your heart rate and blood pressure, digestive system, bladder, sex organs, sweat glands, and eyes. The damage can also lead to hypoglycemia unawareness. Focal Neuropathies Focal neuropathies are conditions in which yo